Interest Groups and Progressive Opposition to Globalization

Abstract

Populist, protectionist, and progressive opposition to free trade is renascent among voters and politicians, but which of these ideologies have successfully inspired interest group mobilization? To answer this question, we collect original data on thousands of groups' participation in highly organized coalitions opposed to US trade agreements. Examining the types of groups that compose these coalitions, variation in activation across issues, and coalitions' written statements suggests their motivations are mainly progressive, focused on the environment, human rights, economic justice, and reducing corporate power. We also focus on progressives' labor union allies, showing that their anti-trade activities are driven by both sincere progressive and classic protectionist motives. This progressive-labor alliance dominates public activism against US trade agreements, and accounts for a majority of trade lobbying and PAC contributions among non-business groups. We conclude that progressive anti-globalism allied to labor is the most organized and enduring non-business interest group opposition to globalization in the US. This opposition has no match on the political right, raising questions about the durability and impact of populist nationalist opposition to trade.

Anti-globalization ideologies are resurgent in American politics. On the right, populist economic nationalism stormed to power in the Republican party and the presidency in 2016; on the left, progressive anti-globalization has been highlighted in presidential campaigns and mass movements. The impact of these ideological currents have been investigated among voters and politicians.[1] But trade politics is a classic site for the influence of special interests, and anti-globalization interest groups have received comparatively less attention in recent scholarship on trade. Understanding their nature, origins, and political impact is therefore a critical gap. To make progress on this, we collect the largest ever dataset of non-business interest group activity around trade and test three competing theories of their mobilization against free trade.

Our theory of these groups begins with the importance of organization. Interest groups provide a link between public opinion and public policy.[2] While relatively disorganized interests can sway elections, voters' preferences are inchoate and multidimensional, and trade may not be a salient issue. Interest groups play an important role in shaping and activating voters' interests, and shape politicians' election performance through mobilization and campaign financing. Interest groups also play a fundamental role *between* elections by supplying work and information to policymakers. They hold politicians to account by monitoring policy developments and threatening to activate opposition. The 'group' in 'interest groups' is particularly important: successful mobilization signals preference intensity and organizational acumen. Politicians listen when organized groups speak.

But what are they saying? We outline three theories of the origins of opposition to trade among non-business interest groups. Populist opposition to globalization comes from right-wing and nationalist groups concerned about economic independence and sovereignty, especially in international agreements. Labor-based protectionism emerges from unions focused on jobs, deindustrialization, and compensation, especially in industries where workers face import competition or offshoring. Unilateral liberalization and trade agreements with strong partners are particularly opposed. Progressive anti-globalism comes from the political left, and includes a constellation of anti-globalization, environmental, human rights, religious, and other identity groups (Ehrlich, 2010, 2018). It focuses on human rights, the environment, corporate power, and economic justice, and so may support unilateral or development-focused forms of trade liberalization even as trade with countries with weak records on the environment and human rights is abjured. For each of these theories, we develop observable implications if that motive is driving interest group organization. These implications focus on the types of groups that compose coalitions; variation across issues in coalition activation; the content of coalitions' texts; and the special role played by labor unions.

To test the relative importance of these competing theories, we assemble a new dataset of

[1] Broz, Frieden and Weymouth (2019); Frieden (2018); Goldstein and Gulotty (2019); Owen and Walter (2017); Ballard-Rosa et al. (2017).

[2] See, e.g., Scheve and Slaughter (2001); Mansfield and Mutz (2013), and much further work cited below.

anti-globalization activity by non-business interest groups in the US.[3] Our original data describes significant coalitional activity among nearly 6000 unique non-business groups. We use this data to build a panel of labor union participation in anti-trade activities which allows us to explore in depth the determinants of union's anti-trade activity. Finally, we match these data sources with the textual output of both anti-globalization coalitions and unions.

Our data on coalition members, macro-level variation across trade issues, coalitions' texts, and labor union activation points strongly in one direction: progressive anti-globalism has been the primary motivant of interest group opposition to trade. Coalitions opposed to globalization and trade agreements are populated by unions; environmental groups; progressive groups; liberal religious organizations; and identity groups. Coalitions are highly organized around the US's free trade agreements – especially with small trade partners with known human rights or environmental concerns – and strikingly absent on development-focused forms of unilateral liberalization like AGOA and GSP. Textual evidence from coalitions reflects progressive motivations: the environment, reining in corporate power, economic justice, and human rights. Import competition is not a main focus. Our new data on coalitions and their texts therefore provides rich quantitative description of the diversity of left-wing groups that have recently opposed free trade, complementing work that has examined demands for free trade among voters or particular subsets of the political left.

Detailed analysis of labor unions' anti-trade activity reinforces the importance of progressive motivations, though protectionism is also operative. Unions express protectionist concerns around jobs and offshoring, and oppose liberalization when their workers are most exposed to foreign competition. However, they also articulate a range of progressive critiques of globalization concerning human rights, green issues, inequality, and foreign development. They reveal their sincere support for these issues through their alliances with progressive groups and their opposition to trade agreements with uncompetitive countries with weak labor rights and environmental standards. Labor unions are therefore an important part of demands for 'fair trade'. We therefore contribute to an ongoing debate over whether unions' demands for strong labor, environmental, and human rights chapters is simply disguised protectionism (Raess, Dür and Sari, 2018; Lechner, 2016; Postnikov and Bastiaens, 2020). Our findings suggest that sincere support for these causes is operative alongside the search for protection (Ahlquist and Levi, 2013; Ahlquist, Clayton and Levi, 2014).

While the composition of anti-free trade coalitions provides clear evidence of organized opposition from the progressive left, we uncover no equivalent mobilization on the right. Only a tiny sliver of groups in our coalitions represent right-wing ideologies; no effective coalitions have been formed with a populist nationalist orientation. So while right-wing populist opposition to globalization has garnered recent attention, we conclude that the activities of left-wing – particularly progressive –

[3] We conceive of 'business' as corporations and other firms as well as industry associations and other business associations. Non-business interest groups are all others falling outside these lines.

anti-free trade groups represent the most enduring opposition to trade in the US.

Our paper proceeds as follows. In Section 1, we introduce our theory, describing first the importance of public and collective forms of organization against free trade, and then three theories of what might motivate that organization: populist nationalism, labor-focused protectionism, and progressive calls for 'fair trade'. Each theory has a corresponding observable implication around: the types of groups forming coalitions, variation in size of coalitions across issues, the topical content of coalitions statements, and on the participation of labor unions. In Section 2, we present our original data on anti-globalization coalitions in the US, and consider each of the first three empirical implications (on membership, activation across issues, and texts). In section 3, we consider the fourth empirical implication on the specific activities of labor unions, examining whether their mobilization across US trade agreements is driven by protectionist or progressive concerns. In section 4, we summarize our main findings and offer some suggestions about the importance of these observations.

1 Anti-Globalization Ideologies and Interest Group Organization

The 2016 US presidential election and subsequent trade war dramatically raised the profile of anti-globalization ideologies: populist nationalism, industrial protectionism, and progressive anti-globalism. These ideologies have been examined among voters and the public. For example, a lively debate has ensued over the role of material and non-material interests in voting for populist right-wing parties.[4] Mass preferences over trade are also shaped by progressive concerns about globalization (Ehrlich, 2010, 2018; Bastiaens and Postnikov, 2020). Politicians' and parties' role in activating anti-trade sentiment have also been investigated (Eichengreen, 2018). Global capitalism's extremes provide fertile ground for political entrepreneurs advocating anti-globalism from both the right and left (Frieden, 2018).

In comparison with the focus on voters and politicians, interest groups have received much less coverage in investigations of the recent anti-trade wave. This may be perfectly reasonable given the popular nature of right-wing nationalism and left-wing anti-globalization. On the other hand, trade politics is the paradigmatic site for interest group politics (Krueger, 1974). Interest groups play an important role in holding politicians to account between elections, and in shaping multidimensional policy outputs in complex areas like global economic regulation. Interest groups may dominate policy formation even beyond these scope conditions (Gilens and Page, 2014). Either way, interest group organization is important to accumulate political resources and solve collective problems

[4] Broz, Frieden and Weymouth (2019); Ballard-Rosa et al. (2017); Owen and Walter (2017); Mutz (2018); Nguyen (2017); Goldstein and Gulotty (2019).

around monitoring, rewarding, and punishing politicians. Recent scholarship has reinvigorated the study of producers' political activity on trade issues – especially pro-trade firms – and argues that they decisively shape trade policy outcomes. It is therefore critical to examine *what role non-business interest groups have played in advancing anti-trade ideologies.*

We limit our investigation of this broad question in two ways, leaving open many avenues for further scholarship. First, we concentrate on a public and collective form of interest group mobilization: the creation of temporary and permanent coalitions. Collective organization is a key objective for interest groups across many issues, including trade. Coalitions unite groups with disparate agendas but shared interests. Coalition formation influences politicians by signaling preference intensity and organizational ability (Kollman, 1998). Coalitions also conduct public campaigns targeting voters, politicians and other groups; coordinate strategy and the sharing of information; and build organizational knowhow, political capital, and infrastructure. While these coalitions are interesting in their own right, they also provide data on revealed preferences that, when matched to political spending, reveal the relative expenditures of competing interest groups.

Second, we have chosen to focus on non-business groups' engagement in collective mobilization, contributions, and lobbying because firms, industry associations, and business associations have already received sustained investigation. Pro-trade forces have been shown to dominate in these areas. Ad hoc coalitions of pro-trade firms and associations were created to support liberalization on every major US trade issue of the past three decades.[5] Publicly pro-trade firms dominate lobbying on trade and corporate campaign contributions, too.[6] In contrast, anti-trade firms and associations have mostly failed to create large public coalitions, and they account for vanishingly small shares of lobbying.[7] We use these extant findings on business groups as benchmarks for our original findings on non-business groups opposed to trade.

Our ultimate goal is to explore the overlap between the rise of anti-globalization ideologies and the renewed focus on the organized special interest politics of trade. We examine whether non-business interest groups in the US have actively opposed trade in recent years, extending the reach of anti-trade ideologies beyond mass publics by creating durable interest group organizations. We investigate whether these groups have employed the political tools – coalition-building, public campaigns, lobbying, campaign contributions – used so effectively by pro-trade producer group. Most importantly, we explore the origins and motivations behind the creation of anti-globalization coalitions, considering three possible accounts: populist right-wing nationalism; labor-centered protectionism; and progressive anti-globalization.

[5] Baccini, Osgood and Weymouth (2019); Osgood (2020).

[6] Kim (2017); Blanga-Gubbay, Conconi and Parenti (2020).

[7] Blanga-Gubbay, Conconi and Parenti (2020); Osgood (2020).

1.1 Populist nationalist opposition to trade and the right

Populist economic nationalism elevates the nation – its people, economy, and institutions – above all others. It has intellectual roots in mercantilist, autarkic, and isolationist ideologies, though in America it is most clearly founded on the commercial protectionism that thrived from the founding of the Republic to the second World War. It is also defined in opposition to the dominant internationalist discourses of political and economic elites.[8]

Contemporary populist nationalist opposition to globalization is a blend of economic and identity-based concerns (Frieden, 2018; Rodrik, 2020). It employs mercantilist tropes about the value of exports over imports, and the importance of national production and trade surpluses. Commercial exchange and trade negotiations are something that the nation either 'wins' or 'losses', in the latter case, probably due to foreign cheating (Carnegie and Carson, 2019). Economic nationalists emphasize self-reliance and view importing and offshoring as unpatriotic. Nationalism seeks to preserve US sovereignty and limit international cooperation. It is also founded on cultural chauvinism and hostility to foreigners (Inglehart and Norris, 2016, p. 7).

Nationalist opposition to trade and globalization mostly comes from the American right. Most recently, nationalist opponents of globalization achieved signal victories with Donald Trump's election and the subsequent initiation of a multi-front trade war (Hafner-Burton, Narang and Rathbun, 2019). Trump mobilized anti-globalization voters by expanding the playbook developed in the populist campaigns of Ronald Reagan, Ross Perot, and Patrick Buchanan (Irwin, 2017, chs. 12-13). It is important to note, however, that the periodic moments of economic nationalism from the Republican Party are the exception to the rule. The party has generally been quite supportive of trade over the past 40 years owing to its close connections to big business, finance, and internationalists supportive of an American-led world order.

While Trump's role in activating voters and redefining the Republican party's coalition is relatively clear, the role of explicitly populist nationalist interest groups opposed to trade and globalization is not. Coverage of such groups has been limited in both academic scholarship and the press. The apparent lack of activity by nationalist interest groups may be a perfectly logical result of the 'popular' nature of populism (which relies more on parties and politicians), or might be due to the only recent resurgence of populist nationalist themes (which went dormant in US trade politics after the NAFTA/WTO debates). We also highlight that some groups that might, in theory, employ populist nationalist rhetoric, like labor unions, have not been found to do so in the large extant literature on their trade activities. Instead they have emphasized the protectionist and progressive motives described below (Margalit, 2019; Lechner, 2016; Hafner-Burton, Mosley

[8] Populist backlash is the subject of a rich recent literature (Broz, Frieden and Weymouth, 2019; Goldstein and Gulotty, 2019; Colantone and Stanig, 2018; Owen and Walter, 2017; Ballard-Rosa et al., 2017, e.g.). See (Hafner-Burton, Narang and Rathbun, 2019; Walter, 2021; Mansfield, Milner and Rudra, 2021, e.g) for reviews.

and Galantucci, 2019; Raess, Dür and Sari, 2018, eg). We thus do not expect *a priori* to find significant mobilization of populist anti-globalist economic groups (or reach of those themes into unions and other groups). But we keep an open mind as we collect and analyze our data, and use our investigation of non-business groups' opposition to trade to investigate the extent of nationalist opposition to trade among American interest groups.

What would we see if popular nationalist motives were a driving force among politically active interest groups? We develop a set of four observable implications concerning *membership*, *issues of interest*, *texts*, and the *participation of unions* among anti-trade coalitions [see Figure 1]. First, if anti-trade coalitions are driven by nationalism, members will come from self-identified right-wing groups or groups with explicitly nationalist or xenophobic agendas. Second, nationalist opponents of trade should be particularly opposed to unilateral or unequal forms of liberalization where market access in the United States is not reciprocated in the partner market. Nationalist opponents of trade might oppose trade agreements more generally, as infringements on sovereignty. Third, the textual content of their opposition to trade should focus on national self-reliance; American identity or superiority; the importance of sovereign independence; and the limited value of international cooperation. Finally, participation among unions will not be driven by trade *per se* but by the extent of right-wing or nationalist political ideology among union leaders or membership.

1.2 Labor-based protectionism and the left

Protectionism among workers or unions is a second potential driver of non-business interest group mobilization. This 'labor-based protectionism' is founded on workers' or labor unions' demands for relief from the negative effects of foreign competition.[9] While opposition to trade may be frankly acknowledged as undesirable because of foreign competitiveness, it is often couched in terms of unfair foreign wages, mistreatment of workers, or illegal trade practices. For example, labor unions employ concerns about human and labor rights to moderate or stymie liberalization (Hafner-Burton, 2011, pgs. 57-59), and may demand stronger human rights and environmental protections when wage pressures are highest (Lechner, 2016; **?**). Demands on human and labor rights also reflect concerns over a generalized global collapse in labor standards with unfavorable competitive implications (Hafner-Burton, Mosley and Galantucci, 2019, p. 1260-61). Of course, labor's concerns with labor rights and and human rights and environmental standards may also reflect sincerely held other-regarding values and not veiled concerns with competition (Ahlquist and Levi, 2013; Ahlquist, Clayton and Levi, 2014). We return to this issue of motivations in the next section, and for now highlight that the 'protectionist' account of labor's preferences emphasizes self-regarding evaluation of trade's material consequences.

[9] Competition from formerly domestic firms that have moved offshore particularly excites opposition to globalization (Owen, 2017; Margalit, 2011).

Table 1: Implications of competing theories of anti-globalization interest group mobilization

	Theory of non-business interest group opposition to trade:		
Empirical implication	**Populist nationalism**	**Protectionism**	**Progressivism**
Membership: types of groups that compose coalitions	Economic nationalist groups allied to right-wing, chauvinist, anti-immigrant, or culturally conservative groups.	Labor unions and locals (possibly allied to anti-trade producer groups).	Left-wing anti-globalization groups allied to progressive, environmental, human rights, left-religious, identity groups.
Issues of interest: variation in coalition mobilization across issues.	Opposition is uniform across trade agreements, or strongest for big multilateral agreements or unilateral liberalization.	Strong opposition to broadest or most economically impactful trade agreements. No support for unilateral liberalization.	Support for unilateral or pro-development programs. Fiercest opposition to countries raising progressive concerns (e.g. on environment or labor rights).
Texts: topical content of letters/policy statements	Self-reliance/economic independence; patriotic or xenophobic themes; sovereign independence; opposition to international cooperation.	Jobs, job loss and wages; offshoring and outsourcing; deindustrialization and economic harms; consequent non-economic harms.	Human/labor rights; environmental concerns; corporate or elite power; inequality and economic justice.
Participation of unions: variation across unions and agreements in joining coalitions.	Union participation is not driven by partner features, but by extent of right-wing nationalist views among members.	Unions participate more when facing import-competition and threats from offshoring especially if work is routinized or blue collar.	Unions more active when partner countries have poor labor rights or environmental records, especially unions with concerns on these issues.

A second key issue in the notion of 'labor-based protecionism' is that not all workers or unions will necessarily oppose trade, and competing models of trade preferences disagree on the links between labor and protectionism. The simplest contemporary approach is a 'mobile factors' model focusing on disputes between white collar and blue collar workers. Because the US has white collar workers in relative abundance, blue collar workers, who are more likely to be unionized, are expected to oppose trade (Scheve and Slaughter, 2001). The leading alternative is the 'specific factors' model: workers of all types in comparative advantage industries will support trade while workers of all types in comparative disadvantage industries will oppose trade (Frieden, 1991). While these models differ on trade cleavages, they both predict that workers/unions in import-competing industries will be more opposed to trade, though that is only 'on average' in the mobile factors model.

Recent work suggests that labor's material preferences over trade may be even more highly articulated. First, exposure to offshoring varies substantially across professions and types of jobs, and has no one-to-one relationship with skill level. Owen and Johnston (2017) argues that workers in the US performing routinized work that is offshorable are particularly susceptible to job loss. Second, firm-level drivers of workers' preferences are operative (Dancygier and Walter, 2015). Workers employed in larger export-competitive firms may be less threatened by trade, for example, although those same large firms are more likely to offshore production or outsource stages of the production process abroad. Third, a large literature has investigated programs or institutions to compensate trade's losers.[10] These multi-faceted set of trade and trade-policy effects may inform the debate described above on the relative importance of material/egoistic and non-material/sociotropic preferences. But the protectionist account is focused on the material/egoistic side, particularly the issues of industrial competitiveness and offshorability.

Regardless of the content and drivers of preferences, workers and unions typically turn to parties of the left to represent their views on trade and other issues. For example, the US Democratic Party has long-running links to the labor movement, and unions are core constituencies and sources of organizational strength for the party. As a consequence, labor-centered protectionism represents one important strand of anti-trade ideology on the political left. This generality requires two qualifications. First, centrist or internationalist Democrats have forcefully supported trade liberalization and global economic integration. Second, some Republican politicians have successfully used anti-trade appeals to secure union votes. Reagan Democrats and the Trump presidential campaign are prominent examples. Thus, not all union opposition to trade is 'left-wing' although the links between unions and the Democratic party are certainly stronger and more enduring than with the Republican party.

Much of the scholarship on workers and unions above describe a 'protectionist' theory of non-

[10]Walter (2017); Owen and Johnston (2017); Hays, Ehrlich and Peinhardt (2005).

business opposition to trade with close but not exclusive ties to the left. This opposition arises primarily from material concerns about trade competition among workers and their unions. If interest group trade opposition fits this 'protectionist' model, several patterns in the mobilization of interest group coalitions are expected to arise. First, opposition to trade should be primarily concentrated among workers and their labor unions. Second, protectionist opponents of trade should be particularly opposed to liberalization with large and competitive economies. They should also oppose unilateral or unequal forms of liberalization where market access in the United States is not matched to any improved market access in a partner market, especially with developing countries with large endowments of (unskilled) labor. Third, the substantive content of opposition to trade should feature concerns about import competition, offshoring, job loss, and wages, though concerns over human rights or the environment may be mentioned as a 'stalking horse' or coalition-building strategy, or as part of concerns over a broader collapse in standards. Finally, opposition to trade should be concentrated among unions representing particular types of workers (e.g. performing routine jobs in offshorable industries) or workers in import-competing industries.

1.3 Progressive opposition to free trade

Progressive opposition to trade arises from a commitment to reform the global economy in line with values associated with the progressive left. These are commitments to economic justice and reduced economic inequality domestically and globally; to human rights, in particular labor rights and the protection of disempowered minority groups; to reduce the political and economic power of large corporations and other owners of capital; and, to the protection of the environment. While one approach has been to view these commitments as a stalking horse for protectionism, contemporary scholarship emphasizes the sincere belief of left-wing voters and groups in these goals (Ehrlich, 2018; Bastiaens and Postnikov, 2020). In this way, preferences over trade are truly multidimensional (Ehrlich, 2010). This literature also emphasizes that opposition to particular trade agreements or globalization *as currently practiced* is not opposition to all trade, but instead a call for global commerce consistent with human rights, equality and development, environmental care, and other key ethical principles.

Progressive argue that globalization has been designed to further the interests of elite corporations. Trade liberalization (and changes in the regulation of foreign investment and capital movements) have empowered large corporations at the expense of SMEs and family farms, and so contributed to the concentration of economic and political power. Globalization has also allowed MNCs to avoid proper taxation, and contributed to other regulatory arbitrage. Trade may also reinforce global inequality, particularly where trade rules are written to deny access of developing markets to the developed world (as in agriculture) or to strengthen the property rights and legal-institutional advantages of large corporations. Inequality, redistribution, and compensation at the domestic level are also important themes in progressive trade rhetoric (Walter, 2010).

Some progressives highlight the benefits of 'fair trade' (Ehrlich, 2018). This includes efforts to grant special access to the developed world markets through the Generalized System of Preferences or a re-designed WTO approach focused on development. Fair trade also takes a micro-level approach, focused on cultivating smaller or family-owned businesses in the developing world or on the proper remuneration of developing world workers and entrepreneurs. Thus, anti-globalization progressivism is often not opposed to global commerce, per se, but to the particular legal institutions and social practices which have shaped who takes the gains from trade in the current global order. 'Free trade' or 'globalization' are negatively contrasted with an unrealized global economic order founded on left-wing principles of social justice: 'fair trade'.

In line with this, progressives have focused on the use of trade policy to further human rights. Workers' rights are a particular focus: labor unions and human rights groups have played key roles in demanding protections for labor in trade agreements.[11] Efforts to tie preferential trade agreements to human rights are also encouraged by progressive groups (Hafner-Burton, 2005). Progressive voters and organizations also make protection of the environment a core feature of their calls for a revised globalization. The environmental movement has sought commitments in trade agreements as one means to improve the impact of globalization on the environment (Morin, Dür and Lechner, 2018; Bastiaens and Postnikov, 2020). Mass support for the linkage of trade and environmental concerns has been demonstrated across several countries (Bernauer and Nguyen, 2015; Spilker, Bernauer and Umaña, 2018).

One particularly interesting question is what role labor unions might play in 'progressive opposition'. Union opposition to trade motivated by protectionism is not 'progressive' as we have defined it. However, one strand of literature has argued that unions' concerns about human rights, the environment, and development are sincere and reflect deeply held values (Ahlquist and Levi, 2013; Ahlquist, Clayton and Levi, 2014). Where trade's effects are heterogeneous or many-layered within professions, which is an especially apt description of contemporary globalization and trade agreements, unions and their members may weigh non-material or sociotropic considerations more strongly. Thus, it is important to critically assess whether unions are an integral part of, or just a strategic and occasional ally of, the non-union groups that oppose trade from a progressive perspective.

Progressive opposition to free trade is a feature of the American left, particularly the progressive wing of the Democratic party and a variety of much smaller alternatives like the Green Party. Their anti-globalism is well-represented in the recent presidential campaigns of Bernie Sanders and Elizabeth Warren, but also in the earlier campaigns of Ralph Nader and Howard Dean. Anti-capitalist/anti-globalization mass movements received significant attention in the US and global debates on the creation of the WTO. Though not a centerpiece of these movements, progressive

[11] Hafner-Burton (2011); Raess, Dür and Sari (2018); Lechner (2016).

critiques of globalization are featured in Occupy Wall Street, MoveOn, and Black Lives Matter.[12]

The views of the voters, movements, organizations and politicians described above comprise a 'progressive' theory of left-wing opposition to globalization. If trade opposition among interest groups is driven by progressivism, these empirical implications follow. First, progressive organizations should play a predominant role in anti-trade activism. Second, progressive opponents of free trade are likely to be more concerned about a partner country's performance in human rights or the environment than about their economic size or competitiveness. They also might favor lopsided or unilateral forms of liberalization with developing countries if these programs are designed to pursue a development agenda. Third, the textual content of opposition to globalization should feature discussion of economic inequality, human and labor rights, the environment, and other concerns with social/economic justice. Finally, opposition to trade among labor unions or workers should not necessarily be concentrated among trade unions facing the most intense import competition. For example, unions representing export-competing industries or non-tradable industries might be active, and they might activate over trade issues with countries that are not trade competitive but provide political opportunities on key progressive agenda items.

2 Trade Opposition among American Interest Groups

Our empirical investigation begins with collection of a new dataset on membership of interest groups in coalitions opposed to US trade agreements and globalization more generally. [We describe these coalitions, and the data cleaning and coding more thoroughly in Appendices A1-2.] As noted above, permanent and issue-specific coalitions are a ubiquitous feature of American trade politics among pro-trade producers. Anti-trade producers have not come close to matching these efforts. The state of play among non-business groups is, by contrast, not well understood. To resolve this issue, we set out to collect information on any public anti-trade coalition from 2000-present with significant membership of non-business groups, including issue organizations, political groups, charities, religious groups, labor unions, and other membership organizations. In so doing, we uncovered a rich vein of coalitional activity among these groups which has not been previously described.

At least one coalition of groups formed to oppose the following trade agreements: the Singapore and Chile FTAs; the Peru-US agreement; the (proposed) Free Trade Agreement of the Americas; AUSFTA; CAFTA-DR; the Oman FTA; the Colombia, Panama, and South Korea FTAs; the Trans-Pacific Partnership; the USMCA; and the proposed Trans-Atlantic Trade and Investment

[12]There is also a large literature on left-wing groups and trade politics in the European Union. (Dür and Mateo, 2014; Dür, Bernhagen and Marshall, 2015, E.g.).

Partnership (TTIP).[13] We found no organized opposition to the trade agreements with Jordan, Morocco, and Bahrain. Looking beyond trade agreements, we also found no organized opposition to major trade initiatives including Permanent Normal Trade Relations (PNTR) for China, the African Growth and Opportunity Act, and the Generalized System of Preferences program.[14] However, we did find organized campaigns against Trade Promotion Authority in 2002, 2007, and 2015.

In addition to campaigns around specific issues, we found four permanent national anti-globalization organizations that are constituted as coalitions: the Citizens' Trade Campaign (CTC), Coalition for a Prosperous America, Alliance for Responsible Trade and the Blue Green Alliance. The CTC is particularly important in anti-globalization advocacy and mobilization. It organized several of the largest *ad hoc* coalitions opposed to trade agreements that appear in our data. We also include an item in our data for groups that appeared in the CTC's state organizations committee, which is separate from its ordinary membership. Finally, we also uncovered 16 regional, state, or municipal anti-globalization or fair trade coalitions which we incorporated as separate items in our data.

The campaign against the Trans-Pacific Partnership illustrates our data. The largest organization opposed to the agreement was a coalition formed by the Citizens' Trade Campaign. This coalition included over 1500 unions, NGOs, charities, religious organizations, and political groups. The coalition sent letters to members of Congress on the likely impacts of TPP on US jobs; the environment; food safety; access to medicines; human and political rights; and the power of investors. In addition to this main coalition, we found several other much smaller coalitions (e.g. of environmental groups, agriculture and food groups, and public health groups). Overall, 2519 separate groups joined coalitions opposing the agreement.

Our resulting data set is structured as a cross section of groups, where each row represents an individual group, for example, Iron Workers Local 397 or the Sierra Club. We then have 38 columns which record if the group joined a coalition opposing one of the issues noted above or any of the permanent groups. We add three additional pieces of information. First, we assign one or several of 21 group type labels to our groups depending on the main focus of their interests and political activities. These labels – 'environmental' for groups focused on the environment; 'union' for labor unions – allow us to summarize the types of groups that have joined these coalitions. The complete set of labels is reported in Table 3; some groups with mixed interests have two or more labels. Second, we match groups wherever possible to lobbying data cleaned and made available by the Center for Responsive Politics.[15] Third, we match groups to data on political action committee (PAC) contributions also from the CRP.

[13] We also include a 2018 coalition which issued a letter identifying priorities for a renegotiated NAFTA as a separate item.

[14] Several of the US's largest labor unions and environmental groups (along with human rights and religious groups) opposed PNTR for China, but not as part of a coalition.

[15] Both of these datasets are available for bulk download at www.opensecrets.org/bulk-data/.

Table 2: **Most-active opponents of trade agreements in non-business coalitions**

Group	Num.	Type(s)
Friends of the Earth	16	environment
AFL-CIO	15	union
Communications Workers of America (CWA)		union
International Brotherhood of Teamsters		union
Sierra Club		environment
United Methodist Church General Board		religious
United Steelworkers		union
Global Exchange	14	humanrights
National Family Farm Coalition		farming
Public Citizen		progressive;antiglob
Western Organization of Resource Councils	13	progressive;environment
Inst. for Agriculture and Trade Policy	10	farming;foodsys
Int. Assoc. of Machinists and Aerospace Workers		union
National Farmers Union		farming
Progressive Democrats of America		progressive
Texas Fair Trade Coalition		fairtrade
UNITE HERE		union
Alliance for Democracy	9	progressive
Americans for Democratic Action (ADA)		progressive
Citizens Trade Campaign		antiglob
Defenders of Wildlife		environment
Family Farm Defenders (WI)		farming
International Brotherhood of Boilermakers		union
International Brotherhood of Electrical Workers		union
Jobs With Justice		laborrights;religious
United Students Against Sweatshops		laborrights
Witness for Peace		forpolicy

Notes: Groups ranked according to number of trade agreements and TPA authorizations for which they joined anti-trade coalitions plus one if they ever joined the Citizens Trade Campaign.

To illustrate this data, Table 2 lists the 27 most active groups. We rank these groups by how many of the 17 trade agreements or fast track/TPA votes on which they joined coalitions, along with whether they ever joined the CTC. The most active group is Friends of the Earth, an environmental organization joined by the Sierra Club in the top 10. Other highly active groups include labor unions (Communications Workers of America, AFL-CIO, Teamsters, and United Steelworkers); religious groups (the United Methodist Church General Board of Church and Society); human rights NGOs (Global Exchange); and general progressive groups (Public Citizen).

Table 3 summarizes our data in its entirety. 5906 unique groups joined coalitions opposing US trade agreements and globalization, or in support of fair trade policies from 2000 to the present. Because some oppose multiple issues or join multiple organizations, our data represent 9650 separate instances of anti-trade activity. These numbers show the great scope of groups that have opposed trade in the US. We also see significant breadth across issues, for example, 2519 groups opposed the TPP and 1038 joined the coalition calling for NAFTA reform. 831, 371, 384, 369, and 421 opposed the Colombia, Korea, CAFTA-DR, Panama, and Oman agreements respectively. Less than 100 joined each of the remaining coalitions opposed to trade agreements. The three TPA coalitions

Table 3: **Group types across anti-trade coalitions**

	Number of groups:		
	In coalitions	Lobbying	Contributing
Labor organizations: 37.6% of total / 42.6% of memberships			
Union locals and branches	2086	14	16
National labor unions	132	34	56
Identity groups: 19.5% of total/ 19.6% of memberships			
Progressive	546	10	39
Religious	304	2	2
Ethnocultural	229	6	3
Women's rights	72	3	4
Environment: 16.8% of total / 16.5% of memberships			
Environmental	715	20	18
Farming	168	1	3
Food systems	108	2	0
Rights groups: 6.2% of total / 7.2 % of memberships			
Labor rights	190	2	0
Human rights	174	5	2
Domestic development: 5.7% of total / 5.0% of memberships			
Community development	212	4	1
Public health	85	5	0
Consumer	39	1	3
Foreign policy: 3.6% of total / 4.5% of memberships			
Foreign policy	125	4	1
Anti-globalization	47	2	2
Foreign development	41	12	0
Company	348	-	-
Trade associations	42	-	-
Other	70	10	2
Total	5906	150	152

Notes: Percentage figures are percentage that ever joined any anti-trade coalition (on left); and, percentage weighted by the number of issues/permanent coalitions on which active (on right).

from 2002, 2007, and 2015 had 9, 725, and 2229 members respectively. These numbers reflect a general ramping up of organized activity over the time period we examine.

2.1 Composition of coalitions by group types

We begin our comparison of the three competing explanations for interest group mobilization against trade and globalization by looking at the types of groups that compose our coalitions. To do so, we examine the broad categories of groups described in Table 3. Unions are the most common group that has opposed trade representing 37.6% of all groups in our data. Much of this size is driven by local chapters of a small set of large, politically active national unions. 877 chapters of the United Steelworkers joined coalitions, for example.

Second most active are groups representing political, religious, ethnic and gender identity-based interests. These are 19.5% of the data. For example, the subcategory of broadly progressive-oriented

political groups includes includes chapters of Occupy Wall Street; Americans for Democratic Action; Democratic Socialists of America; and the Green Party. Interestingly, we see a lot of activity from left or progressive-oriented religious groups, for example, Methodist, Presbyterian and Unitarian congregations or national organizations. Groups representing specific ethnicities or immigrant communities are also highly active, particularly on trade agreements with relevant home countries.

Third largest are groups from the environmental movement. (We include groups interested in farming and food systems under this umbrella, too.) Environmental NGOs, which are the second most active subcategory, play a fundamental role in populating and driving the interests of these coalitions as we show below. Rounding out the groups participating, we see significant action in human and labor rights (6.2% of total); domestic development and public health (5.7% of total); and groups with interests in foreign policy and foreign development (3.6% of total).

Looking over these groups, and considering the important role of the Citizens Trade Campaign and other left-wing national organizations, the dominance of left-oriented groups is evident. In particular, we see an alliance of fundamentally progressive groups from across the issue spectrum, aligned with a subset of national labor unions a few of whom bulk out coalitions with vast numbers of local chapters.

It is also worth highlighting what we did not find: organized right-wing, populist, or nationalist opposition to globalization. None of the coalitions that we uncovered in our investigation were primarily organized or composed of groups representing the American right.[16] We did locate a few organizations within our data with a nationalist slant, e.g., the American Jobs Alliance or the Made in America Movement. However, these groups were only a small subset of the anti-globalization groups in our data, were often explicitly non-partisan, and lack the resources and recognition of our most active left-wing groups.

2.2 Variation in mobilization across issues

Our second category of empirical implications from Table 1 considers variation in the level of organization across issues. A first observation is that trade agreements with developing countries (at least among the partners) seem to spark greater activity than agreements with developed countries only. The TPP, NAFTA/USMCA, and the Colombia FTA particularly stick out, while the Australia FTA provoked a very small coalition and the South Korea FTA generated a half-hearted effort compared with the Colombia agreement. A second observation is that plenty of trade agreements with small markets generated significant mobilization: Colombia, but also Oman and CAFTA-DR. The role of concerns about labor and environmental standards, and the effects of IP provisions and exposure to competition with the US were clear in these cases. That being said the

[16]The Coalition for a Prosperous America comes closest, and has been loudly supportive of the China trade war. CPA is the only majority-producer coalition in our data.

Jordan, Bahrain and Morocco agreements generated no coalitions.

Another striking feature of the data is the issues that generate no coalitional activity. No coalition arose to fight the African Growth and Opportunity Act or Generalized System of Preferences, two legislative efforts that involve the US unilaterally reducing tariffs with developing country partners. We also do not find any significant coalitional activity to oppose extension of Permanent Normal Trade Relations to major developing economies, like China and Vietnam (though some unions and human rights groups strenuously opposed PNTR for China on their own.) Overall, then, the broad variation in activation across issues appears to most consistent with the progressive theory of opposition to free trade.

2.3 Textual evidence on the interests of the coalitions

We now consider our third empirical implication, concerning the textual content of the letters or statements which coalitions generally release. We found 41 such letters across the ad hoc coalitions contained in our data. In order to examine the content of these letters, we coded each paragraph of the letters with at least one of 76 possible topical tags [See Appendix A3]. These tags include mentions of substantive issues (e.g. import competition, jobs, the environment, human rights, tax havens) but also non-substantive material like group introductions or general statements of positions which we do not include in our analysis of topical content. To facilitate presentation, we have bunched the 69 substantive tags we examine into nine thematic categories.

The results from this investigation are presented in Table 4 which lists the 40 most discussed topics. The most discussed issue is the environment, along with related concerns about small farms, SPS measures, and food systems. Procedural concerns around Fast Track/Trade Promotion Authority and the process of collecting input from stakeholders were also widespread. The next set of most common issues include wide-ranging progressive critiques around corporate power, economic justice, human and labor rights, and national sovereignty (in regulatory affairs particularly). Strikingly, only in 7th place do we see direct discussion of foreign competition and protectionism, which is most heavily focused on concern about American workers' jobs and wages, especially the threat of offshoring. That being said, we acknowledge that discussion of environmental or labor standards may reflect protectionist motives. Public health topics and a set of residual concerns about other topics round out the list. We find the overwhelming focus of these letters on progressive concerns to be striking but not surprising given the membership of the groups described above.

Surveying our evidence on groups opposed to trade in the US, we advance the following conclusions. Collective mobilization of non-business groups to oppose trade is widespread and significant over the past two decades. This opposition has primarily come from unions and other groups with a leftward bias in their interests or that are traditional Democratic or progressive constituencies. These groups have shown considerable organizational skill in opposing international trade, forming

Table 4: **Topical content of anti-globalization coalition letters**

	% pars	Rank		% pars	Rank
Environment, farming and food: 20.8% of paragraphs					
Environment	16.6	1	SPS/food safety	1.6	16
Farmers	2.1	12	Food systems	0.5	37
Trade agreement creation and enforcement: 16.1% of paragraphs					
Process (Fast Track/input)	13.1	2	Benchmark	1.4	18
Enforcement	1.6	17			
Corporate power: 14.3% of paragraphs					
Dispute/ISDS	6.3	3	Corporate power	3.6	8
IP rules	4.5	5			
Economic justice: 12.0% of paragraphs					
Foreign development	3.8	7	Small businesses	0.8	30
Immigration	2.5	11	Community dev.	0.7	32
Poverty	2.1	14	Economic growth	0.5	35
Inequality	1.3	20	Downstream industries	0.4	40
Human rights: 9.2% of paragraphs					
Labor rights	5.1	4	Racial justice	0.9	28
Human rights	1.7	15	Women's rights	0.4	39
Indigenous peoples	1.2	21			
Sovereignty concerns: 8.6% of paragraphs					
Regulatory sovereignty	3.2	9	Tax havens	0.8	29
Finance/banking	1.4	19	Capital controls	0.5	36
Govt procurement	1.2	22	Harmonization	0.4	38
Privatization	1.1	24			
Competition and protectionism: 7.4% of paragraphs					
Jobs	2.7	10	Import competition	1.1	26
Foreign investment	1.2	23	Offshoring	0.8	31
Wages/pay	1.1	25	Currency manipulation	0.5	34
Public health: 5.9% of paragraphs					
Pharma/Medicines	3.8	6	Public health	2.1	13
Other topics: 1.6% of paragraphs					
Consumers	1.0	27	Security implications	0.6	33

Notes: Paragraphs are assigned one or more of 69 substantive topics (multiple topics are allocated proportionally). '% of pars' indicates the percentage of all paragraphs focused on a given topic; rank indicates the ranking of that topic among all topics. Only the top 40 most-discussed topics are provided (which are 97% of all substantive discussion).

over 40 ad hoc coalitions and 20 permanent alliances.

The general orientation of the groups and the textual evidence show they are primarily concerned with what we have termed progressive opposition to globalization rather than opposition rooted in protectionist fears of import competition. Right-wing nationalist concerns are almost totally absent among the members of anti-globalization coalitions, and no coalition has formed with a specific nationalist orientation. It is striking the extent to which these groups have not mobilized on unilateral US liberalizations (GSP, AGOA), and were extremely mobilized on liberalization with countries that are no major trade threat but which provoked concerns on labor rights (Colombia, Oman) and the environment (CAFTA-DR). We therefore refer in short to the set of organized

anti-globalization coalitions among non-business groups as 'trade's progressive opposition', though we highlight that this summary glosses over important protectionist inclinations which we now examine.

3 Labor Unions' Opposition to Trade Agreements

Our findings on the importance of progressive motives in special interest groups' anti-free trade activity raise important questions about the labor unions that join these coalitions. Are these unions truly motivated by the progressive themes highlighted in their public communications? Or are they driven by protectionist motives, and alliances with progressive groups are tactical, arising from shared ends – curtailed trade, weakened corporate power – rather than shared progressive values? Investigating these questions covers the fourth and final empirical implications of each of our theories described in Table 1. We proceed in two steps, first examining all unions that have ever joined a coalition and then examining a smaller panel of national union HQs, which allows us to gather additional covariates and investigate unions that are politically inactive in a well-defined sample. Details of our data collection and empirical strategy are provided briefly in the main text and then in Appendix A4.

3.1 Politically active unions' participation in coalitions

To understand the motives behind union participation in anti-trade activity, we examine variation in labor union participation in anti-trade agreement coalitions across the different trade agreements in our data. For example, the International Longshore and Warehouse Union joined coalitions opposing the free trade agreement with Colombia but not the TPP. Is variation in opposition across these agreements driven by the intensity of foreign competition or by concerns about offshorability? Or is opposition driven by the level of respect for labor rights or environmental standards in partner countries in line with progressive anti-globalism?

We use the coalitions data introduced above to construct a panel of all unions – whether national or local – which ever joined one of our anti-trade agreement coalitions. For each union, we record whether it joined a coalition on each of the trade agreements in our data. Our outcome is therefore dichotomous and the unit-of-analysis is the union-agreement. We call this variable *Joined opposing coalition*$_{ua}$ where u represents a politically active union and a a particular trade agreement. The data has 28769 observations (2213 unions $\times$ 13 trade agreements), and *Joined opposing coalition*$_{ua} = 1$ in just under 8% of observations.[17]

[17] Because the presence of local unions might be seen as an undue inflation of our sample size, we reexamine all models using national unions only, where the sample size is at most 1651 (and the outcome is a 1 in 11% of observations).

Our first explanatory variable is an indicator for whether a union's industries are net-importing or net-exporting in relation to the trade agreement's partner(s). To construct this measure, called *Net-importing*$_{ua}$, we use data on bilateral imports and exports of all of the union's 4-digit industries with all of the partners in a trade agreement.[18] A union is net-importing if the sum of all of its industries' imports from all agreement partners exceed exports. The use of fine-grained trade data restricts this analysis to the goods-producing industries only, represented as 'G' in the 'Sample' row of the tables.

Following Owen and Johnston (2017), we also construct union-level measures of *Offshorability*$_u$ and *Routinization*$_u$. Owen and Johnston (2017) argue that worker's opposition to trade is an interactive function of these variables: workers performing non-routine tasks are relative abundant in the US compared to the rest of the world, and may benefit from trade even more if jobs are 'onshored' on to the US. Workers performing routine tasks are vulnerable to trade competition, and doubly so if their jobs are easy to offshore. The original measures of these concepts from Acemoglu and Autor (2011) are occupation-level; we map them to the finest level of NAICS industry possible (usually 6-, 4- or 3-digit) using industry occupation matrices supplied by the Bureau of Labor Statistics. We then average these industry measures across all industries covered by a union's membership. Note that these measures do not vary across trade partners and are not available for 'peak' unions representing a broad array of industries. We therefore test the impact of these union features on unions serving clearly delimited goods and services industries ('G+S' in the tables).

We also include in our models measures of the trade partners' labor rights practices and environmental standards. Our measure of country labor rights practices (*Partner labor rights*$_a$) comes from Mosley (2010). We use the composite labor rights measure ('LaborRightsPos'), which is greater as labor rights improve. Our measure of environmental performance comes from Esty and Porter (2005), from which we use the 'env_rank' variable, which is reversed so higher values indicate better environmental regulation.[19] Both variables are normalized to lie on a unit interval with the minimum country score at 0 and the maximum at 1. In cases of trade agreements with multiple partners, we use the lowest score among the trade partners. Because these variables are agreement partner features, we can analyze goods, services, and 'peak' unions covering broad arrays of industries ('G+S+P'). We estimate models with these two country-level features separately due to our small sample of agreements, and address increasing the identifying variation in the next section.

[18]Trade data are from https://relatedparty.ftd.census.gov/ and are summed over all years between 2005 and 2014. Codings of union industries were done by the authors. Labor federations or coalitions, like the AFL-CIO and its many regional committees, cover a broad array of industries and are not given individual industry codes. We call these 'peak' unions. Some unions cover a broad array of industries but also have clear current or historical industrial relationships, for example, the United Steelworkers or United Auto Workers. For these unions, we employ codings of their main industries so that we can match them to industry-level data.

[19]This measure is not available for Oman.

Table 5: **Protectionist and Progressive Motives among Politically Active Unions**

	Joined opposing coalition$_{ua}$					
	1	2	3	4	5	6
Panel of national and local unions that joined opposing coalitions:						
Net-importing	0.08***	0.08***				
	(0.00)	(0.00)				
Offshorability	0.78***	0.56*	−0.24***	−0.25***		
	(0.20)	(0.21)	(0.06)	(0.06)		
Routinization	0.47***	0.29+	−0.07+	−0.07+		
	(0.13)	(0.13)	(0.03)	(0.03)		
Offshor. · Rout.	−1.31***	−0.92**	0.36***	0.39***		
	(0.31)	(0.32)	(0.09)	(0.09)		
Partner labor rights	−0.16***		−0.16***		−0.16***	
	(0.01)		(0.01)		(0.01)	
Partner env. standards		−0.11***		−0.10***		−0.10***
		(0.01)		(0.01)		(0.01)
Intercept	−0.16+	−0.08	0.19***	0.17***	0.14***	0.12***
	(0.08)	(0.08)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.00)	(0.00)
N	15223	14052	25051	23124	28769	26556
Sample	G	G	G+S	G+S	G+S+P	G+S+P

Notes: Outcome variable is *Joined opposing coalition*$_{ua}$ measuring whether union u joined coalition opposing trade agreement a. All models are linear probability models using OLS. G = unions representing (at least some) goods industries; S = unions representing service industries only; P = 'peak' unions representing a broad array of industries. National and local unions joining coalitions are any union HQ, branch, local, or committee that joined at least one of the opposing coalitions in our data. Locals are union branches or locals that have a parent union at the national level.

To ease interpretation, particularly in light of the many dummy variables and variables normalized to fall on the unit interval, we employ linear probability models in all specifications.

The results from our models are presented in Table 5. We find that import competition is a correlate of unions' participation in anti-trade agreement coalitions. A given goods industry union in our data is around 8% more likely to oppose an agreement when it is net-importing relative to the agreement partner(s). The results on offshorability and routinization are somewhat inconsistent across specifications, but the most common pattern in the results is that offshorability and routinization are jointly related to opposition to trade from unions, as argued in Owen and Johnston (2017). Overall, we conclude that unions have been more likely to join anti-trade agreement coalitions where competition from foreign workers and producers is stronger.

At the same time, we also see that progressive motives are operative. Participation in coalitions occurs at noticeably lower rates when the agreement partner's labor rights are strong or when environmental standards are high. The effects of these variables are noticeable, too. For example, moving *Partner labor rights* from its highest to its lowest value in the data (1 to 0) increases the predicted chance of participating in an anti-trade agreement coalition by 16%. These effects are even larger among national unions. While it is possible that these associations might arise from fears about lower regulatory standards, these relationships hold conditional on net-importingness of the union relative to that trade partner. They are also identical in unreported models using

continuous trade measures. We also examined models interacting partner labor or environmental standards with net-importingness of the industry [reported in Appendix B]. We found no evidence net-importing industries are especially vocal about opposing agreements when labor rights are poor, for example.

3.2 Extension to all national unions

In this section we address important extensions of the above analysis. First, we include unions who have never joined an anti-trade coalition. Their non-participation may reveal further information about union attitudes on trade. Second, we collect data on additional union-level features that might drive political engagement but which are only available for national unions in the US. Third, we incorporate inter-union variation in self-expressed progressive motives in order to expand our identifying variation for testing a progressive theory of union anti-trade activity.

Accomplishing these goals required construction of an alternative panel of national unions. To do so, we employed data provided by the Office of Labor-Management and Standards at their Online Public Disclosure Room portal.[20] We queried the database for all union national headquarters active after 2011, and then restricted that sample to national unions with either 100 recorded members or $10000 in receipts. This left 138 unions as the foundation for our panel which we then matched to data on coalition memberships across trade agreements. Note that we have unions incorporated into our sample who have never politically engaged on trade issues. The OLMS-OPDR data also provide us with important union features which might predict political activity: total union receipts, number of members, and whether the union has a PAC.

We then used the websites of these unions to understand their specific interests in trade issues. Only 38 of the 138 national unions had any mention of trade issues on their websites. 19 of these mentioned labor rights issues as a specific concern around globalization. 15 of these mentioned environmental concerns in the context of their positions on trade.[21] We use these web mentions to construct two variables: *Website labor rights*$_u$ is a dichotomous variable equal to 1 if the union mentioned labor rights concerns around globalization. *Website environment*$_u$ is defined analogously. We then ask the following question: are the labor unions that express an interest in labor rights issues more likely to oppose trade agreements with partners that have worse labor rights records? If so, then we argue that these statements are likely sincere expressions of concern about these issues, particularly conditional on import competition and susceptibility to automation and offshoring.

The results from this analysis are contained in Table 6. As in our previous results, we find that net-importingness remains a positive correlate of participation in anti-trade agreement coalitions.

[20] https://olms.dol-esa.gov/olpdr/.

[21] By way of comparison, 30 of 38 mentioned concerns about jobs or wages and 14 mentioned offshoring specifically.

Table 6: **Protectionist and Progressive Motives among Panel of National Unions**

	Joined opposing coalition$_{ua}$					
	1	2	3	4	5	6
Panel of national unions:						
Net-importing	0.08*	0.10**				
	(0.03)	(0.03)				
Offshorability	−0.48	−0.46	−0.23*	−0.27*		
	(0.48)	(0.52)	(0.10)	(0.11)		
Routinization	−0.02	0.12	−0.27***	−0.23***		
	(0.32)	(0.33)	(0.06)	(0.06)		
Offshor. · Rout.	1.00	0.92	0.76***	0.85***		
	(0.87)	(0.93)	(0.18)	(0.19)		
Website Labor Rights	0.42***		0.28***		0.32***	
	(0.07)		(0.03)		(0.03)	
Partner labor rights	−0.05		−0.08**		−0.07**	
	(0.06)		(0.02)		(0.02)	
Web LR · Partner LR	−0.60***		−0.25***		−0.25***	
	(0.12)		(0.06)		(0.06)	
Web Environment		0.32***		0.21***		0.24***
		(0.09)		(0.04)		(0.03)
Partner env. standards		−0.06		−0.05		−0.05+
		(0.06)		(0.03)		(0.02)
Web Env · Partner env.		−0.37+		−0.18*		−0.16*
		(0.17)		(0.07)		(0.07)
ln Receipts	0.02*	0.02*	0.01**	0.01**	0.00	0.00
	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.00)	(0.00)	(0.00)	(0.00)
ln Members	0.03*	0.04**	0.01	0.01*	0.01***	0.01***
	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.00)	(0.00)	(0.00)	(0.00)
Has PAC	−0.12+	−0.13	0.05*	0.03	0.02	0.01
	(0.06)	(0.07)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)	(0.02)
Intercept	−0.45**	−0.54**	−0.07	−0.12*	−0.11**	−0.13***
	(0.16)	(0.16)	(0.04)	(0.04)	(0.03)	(0.03)
N	377	348	1430	1320	1794	1656
Industries	G	G	G+S	G+S	G+S+P	G+S+P

Notes: Outcome variable is *Joined opposing coalition*$_{ua}$. All models are linear probability models using OLS. G = unions representing (at least some) goods industries; S = unions representing service industries only; P = 'peak' unions representing a broad array of industries. National unions are national union HQs based in the US with at least 100 members or $10000 in receipts, and operating after 2011.

Offhshorability and routinization also jointly predict opposition to trade. We again find that worse partner labor rights or environmental standards are linked to a greater chance of opposition. However, we also find that the effects of weakened standards are particularly strong for unions that have expressed concerns about labor rights or environmental standards on their websites. In other words, particular American unions are self-describing labor rights and the environment as motivating concerns, and those unions are especially likely to oppose trade agreements with partners with poor records on those dimensions. These patterns hold when controlling for important features of union's exposure to trade competition. The simplest interpretation of these findings is that some labor unions have genuine progressive concerns around labor rights and the environment which drive, at least in part, their opposition to US trade agreements.

3.3 Textual evidence on unions

To further investigate the motives of America's national unions in participating in trade politics, we do a detailed investigation of textual evidence of their trade positions. We scoured the 138 national unions' webpages focused on pages labeled 'issues', 'public policy', 'campaigns', 'activism', and so on for general positions about international trade and globalization issues. If we were unable to find positions on trade generally, we searched for statements on one of three recent issues: the TPP, the USMCA, and the China trade war. As noted above, we found statements from 38 unions. We then topically coded the documents in exactly the same manner that we did the coalition letters examined in Table 4.

In Table B2, we find that concerns about foreign competition are preeminent in labor unions' discussions of trade issues, particularly a heavy focus on jobs, offshoring, and concerns about pay. Perhaps unsurprisingly, labor rights and concerns about corporate power are also major topics. We see significant secondary discussions of issues around economic justice, sovereignty, the environment, human rights, and public health that are consistent with progressive critiques of globalization.

We advance the following summary conclusions on unions' participation in anti-globalization activities. Unions' decisions about which issues to engage on reflect a mix of both protectionist and progressive motives. On one hand, they are more active in opposing agreements when their industry is at a comparative disadvantage, and unions whose members are more vulnerable to offshoring are more active, too. Unions' web statements on trade and globalization highlight most prominently their concerns about jobs, offshoring, and foreign competition. However, unions are also active in opposing agreements with countries with poor labor and environmental standards even conditional on the competitiveness of those partners. Unions have been very active in opposing trade issues where foreign competition is not a plausible concern but progressive concerns about human and labor rights are, and they describe these concerns in some detail on their websites. They have also not formed coalitions to oppose unilateral pro-development forms of liberalization. Perhaps most importantly, they have closely allied themselves with progressive groups in order to oppose trade and they have allowed a progressive message to take center stage in those coalitions' communications.

4 Conclusion

We conclude by summarizing our main contributions, describing their connections with ongoing debates in the literature, and discussing some limitations to our approach. Following up on this discussion, we then briefly outline our tentative answers to two remaining questions – why have progressives been so successful, and does it matter? – highlighting these as areas for future research.

We began by emphasizing the importance of public coalitions in contemporary trade politics

(and other issue areas), while identifying a gap in the literature: the causes and extent of these coalitions are not clear among non-business groups. To explain these coalitions we developed three competing theories of their genesis rooted in populism, protectionism among workers, and progressive calls for 'fair trade'. We found that populism is largely not a driver of anti-trade coalitional activity among interest groups. While recent literature has highlighted the role of populism among voters and after Trump's takeover of the Republican party, it is striking that there is not historically (and still does not seem to be) a corresponding development of right-wing interest groups articulating nationalist themes around trade. Given the importance of interest groups in highlighting issues and holding politicians accountable, this raises doubts to us about the durability of the 'populist backlash' against globalization.

Rather than reflecting right-wing populism, the coalitions opposed to US trade policies and globalization generally have left-wing or progressive features. They are populated with a wide variety of progressive groups, and activate to oppose trade agreements with some uncompetitive countries (while supporting or not opposing programs of unilateral liberalization to facilitate development). They heavily emphasize progressive themes in their letters and other public commentary. It is striking how little jobs and wages are discussed by these coalitions given their heavy union membership. These observations lead to our second main conclusion: non-business opponents of globalization pushing a progressive program emphasizing labor and human rights, foreign development and sovereignty, and the environment, are highly organized in the US and represent the dominant strand of public activism against globalization. We call these groups "free trade's progressive opposition". Our work therefore complements scholarship on demands for fair trade among voters and the role of progressive groups in shaping trade agreement provisions.

Finally, the strong emphasis on progressive themes in these coalitions raises questions about labor unions, progressives' stalwart allies. The recent literature on unions and trade has often emphasized that unions support labor rights, human rights, and environmental protections for tactical reasons, whether it is to disguise overt protection directed against a specific trade agreement partner or to avert a general collapse in global standards. Alternatively, some have argued that unions often have sincerely held beliefs in progressive causes. We believe our findings support both accounts. On one hand, unions *are* more active in joining coalitions to oppose agreements with competitive trade partners (and if their workers are more vulnerable to offshoring). On the other hand, unions seem to be strongly motivated to fight against agreements with countries with weak records on the environment or labor rights. This includes prominent examples where strong protectionist motives are doubtful. They mention these concerns on their websites, and they are happy to cede territory on these concerns to more progressive notions in coalitions' letters. The most sensible interpretation of these facts is that some US labor unions have abiding and genuine interests in fairer trade, including trade that benefits foreign workers and foreign development.

We highlight several weaknesses in our approach. First, we focus mainly on public coalitions.

These coalitions are only one facet of interest group activity in US trade politics, and so it would be useful to consider how are findings travel to other domains such as lobbying, notice & comment, and advisory committees. Second, our study of variation in activity across agreements is limited by the number of trade agreements. Scholars should seek out sites for trade politics where more trade partners are under consideration to test theories of interest groups in trade. Third, data on non-union interest groups is generally quite limited, and in many ways hard to conceptualize because the features and interests of non-union groups are so disparate. For this reasons, we have been forced to reserve our regression-based tests for unions only, and our analysis of non-union groups is more descriptive in nature.

Finally, we turn to two unanswered questions: why are progressives better organized, and does it matter? We hope that our tentative answers will spark interest in future research.

We see two possible advantage for progressives which relate to classic themes in the study of collective action. First, the spine of free trade's progressive opposition is a group of very large union and non-union organizations with huge budgets. As seen in Table 2, they repeatedly turn out to organize collective opposition to liberalization. They are then supplemented by a vast array of smaller groups whose participation is less reliable and whose political resources are fewer. Thus, progressive groups have benefitted from heterogeneities in size within their ranks as smaller organizations can rely on bigger organizations to pay the costs of organization.

Second, contemporary globalization is multifaceted and complex in its effects and preference intensity is generally low on trade issues. This is (counterintuitively) advantageous because the major progressive groups that have opposed free trade have built themselves in issue areas with much higher preference intensity (the environment, human rights, identity politics) and/or arise in spheres where selective benefits prevail (labor unions, religious organizations). Particular elements of the expanded trade agenda or of globalization politics then lead to their involvement in the complex politics of trade. Progressive critiques about reshaping or reforming globalization – rather than ending it – are also usefully flexible. A uniformly anti-trade position is tricky because opting out of globalization is impossible in the 21st century. Labor unions, for example, may support one agreement as they oppose some element of another. These complexities drain some of the verve from raw protectionism, and lead instead towards more flexible ideologies, like the multi-faceted progressive critique.

Populist nationalism doesn't have these advantages. It lacks a well-organized set of highly resourced groups focused on anti-globalism, and it also does not benefit from well-organized interest groups from other domains in right-wing politics who might dip into anti-trade politics. Socially conservative groups, gun rights groups, and right-wing churches have no stake in trade politics, while right-wing business groups, anti-tax groups, libertarians, think tanks, and general conservative groups are pro-trade. Ultimately, economic nationalism is a mass movement, so populism probably needs a party. The long-run durability of right-wing economic nationalism probably depends more

on the coalitional politics within the Republican Party, an uneasy fit for economic populists given Republicans' historic links to corporate America and laissez faire economic ideologies.

Has progressive opposition to trade had any impact on policy? We examine a proximate outcome in the appendix, where we match our data on coalition participation to data on lobbying and PAC contributions. We find that groups that have joined our anti-trade coalitions account for more than 60% of all lobbying on trade by non-business groups, and 46.4% of all non-business group PAC contributions. These facts suggest that politicians are motivated to listen to progressives and unions when they speak on trade issues, and are actively responding to them and working with them.

Anecdotal evidence of progressives' influence on trade policy are also available. First, trade's progressive opponents and allied unions have cultivated representation in the Congress and the Democratic Party. The House of Representatives, in particular, has a significant share of members that vote in a progressive fashion on trade issues, many of whom are members of the Congressional progressive caucus. Second, free trade's progressive opponents have shaped the trade agenda of the Congress and the Democratic Party platform. Progressives successfully fought to make labor standards and the environment principle trade negotiating objective in the Trade Act of 2002. The TRADE Act and "Better Deal" economic blueprint are more recent efforts by Democrats to reshape trade policymaking, though they lead to no passed legislation. Recent Democratic party platforms emphasize a mix of progressive and labor-protectionist concerns on trade issues. Finally, progressive concerns have had a tangible impact on the content of US trade agreements. The "May 10th agreement" led to fully enforceable labor and environmental provisions in US trade agreements of the Obama era. Modernizing these provisions was a focus of the TPP negotiations and the negotiation of the USMCA. Progressives have successfully fought against certain extensions of IP or dispute settlement rights for corporations. At the same time, it must be acknowledged that anti-trade progressives have had fewer outright victories than America's pro-globalization firms and industries. Their record of organizational success and ongoing, but modest, political impact suggests that they will continue to work as the most vital ideological component among America's anti-trade interest group coalitions.

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Appendix A: Data and Empirical Strategy

Ad hoc coalitions and permanent groups

The table below lists all of the coalitions recorded per issue (usually free trade agreements but also three instances of trade promotion authority previously known as Fast Track). Note that some coalitions cover multiple issues and are listed multiple times. Each coalition consists of a list of members ranging from the tens to the thousands as mentioned in the main text. All members of coalitions covering a single issue or agreement were combined together to form the list of groups opposing that issue/agreement. For example, multiple coalitions formed to oppose the TPP comprising a total of 2519 unique groups that join at least one coalition opposed to the TPP. Groups whose names are rendered in different ways across documents were matched together by hand by the authors. Finally, all of the groups that opposed issues or agreements (or joined the state or national coalitions described below) were merged into a common dataset, which identifies all agreements/issues that a group opposed and all national or state-level coalitions that a group joined. As before, groups whose names are rendered in different ways different issues or coalitions were matched together by hand by the authors.

Agreement/Issue	Coalition description and code
TPA (2002)	Citizens Trade Campaign letter on the Fast Track bill H.R. 3009 (FTCTC)
Chile FTA	Citizens Trade Campaign press release on Chile (CTCCHL)
	Environmental groups letter (ENVCHL)
	CTC letter on Singapore and Chile (CTCSNGCHL)
Singapore FTA	Environmental groups letter (ENVSING)
	CTC letter on Singapore and Chile (CTCSNGCHL)
	CTC Singapore letter (CTCSING)
Australia FTA	CTC press release on Australia FTA (CTCAUS)
FTAA	Stop the Free Trade Agreement of the Americas Coalition (STPFTAA)
Oman FTA	Citizens Trade Campaign Oman Sign-on Letter (CTCOMAN)
Peru TPA	Afro-Latino Groups Letter on Colombia and Peru (CADC)
	Concerned Peruvian Americans letter (IMFAITH)
	Environmental groups letter to Congress (ECG)
CAFTA	Stop CAFTA coalition (STPCAF)
	Environmental groups letter on Senate passage (SENPASOFCAF)
	Environmental groups letter on CAFTA (ENVCAF)
	Second environmental groups letter on CAFTA (ENVCAF2)
	Salvadoran social movements letter (POSOFSALSOC)
	Central American civil society letter (CIVLET)
	Salvadoran American National Network letter (SANN)
	Washington Office on Latin America letter (WOLA)

TPA (2007)	Fast Track opposition signs on letter to Majority Leader Reid and Speaker Pelosi (FTSOL)
	Interfaith Working Group letter to Representatives (IWG)
Panama FTA	Citizens Trade Campaign letter to Ambassodor Kirk (CTCCPK)
	Environmental groups letter to Congress (ECG)
	Seven groups letter to Ron Kirk (SGLTPCK)
	Environmental groups letter on Panama to Congress (ENVPAN)
	Citizens Trade Campaign letter on Panama (PUBCIT)
Colombia FTA	Afro Latino Groups Letter on Colombia and Peru (CADC)
	Colombia Letter to Members of Congress (COLCOAL)
	Citizens Trade Campaign letter to Ambassodor Kirk (CTCCPK)
	Environmental groups letter to Congress (ECG)
	Seven groups letter to Ron Kirk (SGLTPCK)
KORUS	Citizens Trade Campaign letter to Ambassodor Kirk (CTCCPK)
	Environmental groups letter to Congress (ECG)
	Seven groups letter to Ron Kirk (SGLTPCK)
TPA (2015)	Citizens Trade Campaign letter to Members of Congress (CTCFT)
	Citizens Trade Campaign letter to Representative/Senator (CTCFT2)
	Fast Track coalition letter to Representatives and Senators (FTTPP)
	Labor movement united letter to senators/representative (RCFT)
	Environmental and science organizations letter to members of the US Congress (FTENV)
TPP	Citizens Trade Campaign letter to Members of Congress (CTCTPP)
	Bio groups to Obama (BIOTPP)
	Citizens Trade Campaign letter to Representative/Senator (CTCTPP2)
	Environment Letter on the TPP and Fossil Fuels (ENVTPP)
	Farm and food coalition letter (FAFOTPP)
	Americans for Financial Reform (FINTPP)
	Fast Track coalition letter to Representatives and Senators (FTTPP)
	Transparency letter to TPP Minsters and Heads of Delegation (TRANSTPP)
	Transparency concerns letter on TPP (USTRF)
NAFTA Reneg.	Citizens Trade Campaign Letter on Priorities in NAFTA Renegotiation (CTCNAFREN)
USMCA	Public Citizen Letter (NAF2PC)
TAFTA/TTIP	Undersigned Organizations' Letter on TAFTA (TAFTALETT)

We also incorporate into our data a number of permanent (or non-issue specific) national and sub-national organizations that have opposed trade or supported fair trade campaigns. These are listed below:

Permanent national organizations:
Citizens Trade Campaign
Coalition for a Prosperous America
Alliance for Responsible Trade
Blue Green Alliance
CTC State Coalition members.

Permanent regional, state or municipal organizations:
Oregon Fair Trade Campaign
Oregon Fair Trade Coalition
NYC Fair Trade Coalition
Pennsylvania Fair Trade Coalition
Texas Fair Trade Coalition
Washington Fair Trade Coalition
Arizona Fair Trade Coalition
California Fair Trade Coalition
Chicago Fair Trade
Colorado Fair Trade Coalition
Florida Fair Trade Coalition
Ohio Conference on Fair Trade California Trade Justice Coalition
Maine Fair Trade Campaign
Minnesota Fair Trade Coalition
New Hampshire Fair Trade Coalition.

Group categories

The authors coded groups into one or several of the following 21 categories described below. Each categorization was done by hand by one of the authors, and unclear cases were examined by both authors. Groups may be categorized into multiple categories. For example, Public Citizen was categorized as both a general progressive group and a specifically antiglobalization group. Groups that are coded into several categories are reweighted (for example, for the summary statistics in Table 3). For example, a group with three type labels counts as 1/3 of a group for each of the three separate labels.

antiglob: groups focused on opposition to trade or globalization.
citizen: individuals that are individually named as members of coalitions (e.g. academics or attorneys).
commdevelopment: groups focused on local community issues or development.
company: corporations and other individual producers.
consumer: groups focused on consumers protections or consumer right.
environment: NGOs focused on environmental issues.
ethnocultural: groups supporting specific racial or ethnic groups, or immigrants from particular countries.
fairtrade: organizations focused specifically on fair trade.
farming: groups primarily representing farmers (but not agricultural trade associations).
foodsys: groups focused on food safety or security (e.g. non-GMO or environmentally-friendly food production).
fordevelopment: groups focused on issues of development, primarily in the developing world.
forpolicy: groups seeking to change US foreign policy or to promote international peace.
humanrights: groups focused on human rights generally.
laborrights: groups focused on workers' rights and labor outcomes (but not unions).

progressive: generally left-wing or progressive groups without a specific issue area focus, including parties.
pubhealth: groups focused on public health issues, or that are primarily composed of health practitioners (but are not labor unions or professional associations).
religious: churches, synagogues, and other religious groups whether national or individual congregations.
tradeassoc: any association that represents a US industry or profession.
union: labor unions.
unknown or other: group issue could not be identified or clearly fit into some other category that was not otherwise present.
womensrights: groups focused specifically on women's rights.

Paragraph topics for textual data

All paragraph topics in coalition letters or union documents were assigned by hand by the authors. The complete set of topics (rendered as slightly longer descriptions rather than the very short tags we employed) are presented in Table A2. Each paragraph was given at least one of the topics described in the main text (though some paragraphs of irrelevant material were simply called the topic 'nonrel'). Our list of topics was generated from an initial reading of the documents; our own substantive knowledge from a previous project coding submissions and Congressional testimony; and, from subsequent readings in the course of coding the paragraphs. We refined and added topics as needed in the course of the project, and then rechecked earlier usages to ensure conformability.

Paragraphs with multiple topics are counted as fractional paragraphs for purposes of summing up total numbers of topics per testimony. For example, a paragraph with two topics would contribute 1/2 a paragraph to the count for each topic discussed in that testimony. Our first 7 topics on 'Nonrelevant material' and 'Political commentary' (excluding Policymaking process) are excluded from the denominator for calculating proportions because they are generally 'pro forma' in nature.

Table A2: Topics used in coding hearing content

I: Nonrelevant material:	
Introduction	Outro
Non-relevant	
II: Political commentary:	
Position on agreement	Revisions to agreement
Agreement timetable	Political mobilization
Policymaking process	
III: Ordinary trade:	
Bilateral trade (expansion)	US exports
Foreign barriers reduced	Foreign barriers remain
Import competition	Domestic barriers reduced
Domestic barriers remain	US trade deficits
Foreign trade agreements	Currency manipulation
Upstream industries affected	Downstream industries affected
IV: Foreign sourcing and investment:	
Sourcing of intermediates	FDI
Capital controls	Offshoring (of jobs)
V: Broader effects, economic and non-economic:	
Jobs	Wages
Farmers	Economic growth
Producer productivity	Consumers
SMEs	Economic development
Economic security	Inequality
Poverty	Community/local development
Indigenous	Racial
Ethnic	Women
VI: Expanded trade agenda:	
SPS measures	Government procurement
Standards (in general)	Reg. harmonization
Technical barriers	IP rights
Pharmaceuticals	Environment
Tax havens	Safeguards
Rules of origin	Subsidies
SOEs	Dumping
Customs facilitation	Other domestic policies
e-Commerce	TRIMs
Immigration	Enforcement
Labor rights	Human rights
Food systems	Public health
Competition policy	Corporate power
Privatization	Dispute settlement
Benchmark agreement	Immigration
Financial regulation	
VII: Broader strategic issues:	
Alliance/friendship	Democratization
Security issues	US trade leadership
Agreement broadening	

Samples, data construction, and regression analysis of labor unions

Our regression-based analysis of labor unions' participation in anti-trade coalitions proceeds in two parts which we describe in turn. First, we examine all unions in the United States that have ever joined one of the coalitions described above, exploiting variation across trade agreements in their participation in coalitions. Second, we examine all unions (whether they have joined a coalition or not), but focus on national union HQs to define our sample. We describe our sample, data, and empirical strategy for each case.

Unions that joined coalitions: Table 5 in the main text (and Tables B1, B4, B5, B6) examine unions that have joined one of the coalitions described above that is in opposition to a US trade agreement (and so do not examine other major national unions or their locals that have not joined a coalition). We focus only on trade agreements so that we can examine the impact of partner-country features on unions' choices to oppose trade. We focus only on unions that have actively joined coalitions that we can define the broadest possible set of potential participants, and then focus on variation across agreements. In the models below, we examine a fixed panel of National union HQs that is much smaller, but includes unions that have never opposed a trade agreement.

Our data at its largest contains $16 * 2213 = 35408$ observations. The 16 blocs in the data are defined by 13 major passed US trade agreements post-2000 (Australia, Bahrain, CAFTA-DR, Chile, Colombia, Jordan, Morocco, Oman, Panama, Peru Singapor, South Korea, USMCA) as well as two failed agreements (FTAA, TPP) and one additional coalition that formed to demand a renegotiated NAFTA (that was issued before the USMCA was unveiled). Because the Bahrain, Jordan, and Morocco agreements generated no coalitions, we drop those agreements from the main analysis leaving $13 * 2213 = 28769$ observations. (We reexamine our models with these agreements included in the appendix Tables B4 and B5.) The 2213 units per bloc represent all 2213 US unions that have ever joined one of the coalitions described above, regardless of whether they are national, regional, state, or local (and including HQs, branches, locals etc). We refer to these as 'politically active' unions. Note that we do not include groups with multiple group types (of which one is union) in these analyses.

Our samples are made more complex by the fact that some data are unavailable for certain types of unions. For example, what we call 'peak unions' represent vast number of industries (we call these 'P' in the regression Tables). So it is not meaningful to assign them industry-specific data, like the measures of offshorability and routinization. Unions representing services industries (S) cannot be matched to fine-grained trade data. Unions representing Goods-producing industries (i.e. agriculture, manufacturing, and mining) generally have the most data available. For these reasons, we examine all of the correlates of union participation in coalitions across three samples: only goods industries (G); goods and services (G+S); and all politically active unions (G+S+P). Some variables are also missing for some industries which can modestly further shrinks some of the usable samples.

We use the following notation to subscript our variables. A lower case u subscript refers to a particular union among the 2213 we examine. A lower case a subscript refers to a particular trade agreement. Our main explanatory variable is *Joined opposing coalition*$_{ua}$ which is equal to 1 if a particular union joined any coalition opposing a particular agreement.

We include the following explanatory variables in some or all of our models:

1. *Net-importing*$_{ua}$ $\in \{0, 1\}$ is an indicator for whether a union's industries are net-importing or net-

exporting in relation to the trade agreement's partner(s). To construct this measure, we use data on bilateral imports and exports of all of the union's 4-digit industries with all of the partners in a trade agreement. The trade data are from https://relatedparty.ftd.census.gov/ and are summed over all years between 2005 and 2014. Codings of unions to one or several 4-digit NAICS industries were done by the authors. A union is net-importing if the sum of all of its industries' imports from all agreement partners exceed exports. The use of fine-grained trade data restricts this analysis to the goods-producing industries only, represented as 'G' in the 'Sample' row of the tables.

2. *Offshorability*$_u$ is a union-level measure which builds off of data and conceptualization from Acemoglu and Autor (2011). The original data on the 'offshorability' of jobs is coded at the 6-digit SOC occupation-level. We map the offshorability of occupations to the finest level of NAICS industry possible (usually 6-, 4- or 3-digit) using industry occupation matrices supplied by the Bureau of Labor Statistics (https://www.bls.gov/emp/tables/industry-occupation-matrix-industry.htm. We then average these industry measures across all industries covered by a union's membership to determine the union's net exposure to offshoring. This variable is normalized to fall on the unit interval.

3. *Routinization*$_u$ is also a union-level measure again built off of Acemoglu and Autor (2011). The original coding and our translation to a union-based measured is almost totally similar to the case of offshorability, with a mapping from occupation, to industry, to union. This variable is also normalized to fall on the unit interval.

4. *Partner labor rights*$_a$ is a country-level measure of respect for labor rights which comes from Mosley (2010). We use the composite labor rights measure ('LaborRightsPos'), which is greater as labor rights improve. This variables is normalized to lie on a unit interval with the minimum country score at 0 and the maximum at 1. In cases of trade agreements with multiple partners, we use the lowest score among the trade partners.

5. *Partner env. standars*$_a$, our measure of environmental performance, comes from Esty and Porter (2005). We use the 'env_rank' variable, which is reversed so higher values indicate better environmental regulation. Note that this measure is not available for Oman (nor Bahrain and Morocco). This variables is normalized to lie on a unit interval with the minimum country score at 0 and the maximum at 1. In cases of trade agreements with multiple partners, we use the lowest score among the trade partners.

Panel of national union HQs: Table 6 in the main text (and Table B7 in the appendix) examine a panel of unions that includes both unions that did and did not ever join a coalition opposing a US trade agreement. We focus on a well-defined set of national unions HQs which is available Office of Labor-Management and Standards' Online Public Disclosure Room portal [https://olms.dol-esa.gov/olpdr/.] We queried the database for all union national headquarters active after 2011, and then restricted that sample to national unions with either 100 recorded members or $10000 in receipts. This left 138 unions as the foundation for our panel.

We then matched these unions to our data on union membership in anti-trade agreement coalitions, so we know whether each of the 138 unions opposed one of the trade agreements described above. As a result, our complete panel dataset (absent Bahrain, Jordan, and Morocco) has a sample size of $138 * 13 = 1794$

observations. As above, we end up using restricted samples depending upon which variables are included in the models. Our main explanatory variable is again *Joined opposing coalition*$_{ua}$ which is equal to 1 if a particular union joined any coalition opposing a particular agreement.

Our models examining national union HQs employ all of the explanatory variables 1-5 described just above. In addition, we introduce an additional set of controls:

6. *Website Labor Rights*$_u$ is a union-level variable which measures whether a union mentions labor rights concerns on its website in relation to its general positioning on trade issues. (Unions and other groups sometimes include 'issues' or 'policy' pages where they describe their positions on key issues). 19/138 unions mentioned labor rights on their web pages where they discuss international trade (38/138 discussed trade in any fashion).

7. *Website Environment*$_u$ is an analogous variable which mentions discussion of the Environment in relation to trade on the webpage. 15/138 unions mentioned environmental concerns on their web pages where they discuss international trade.

8. *Receipts*$_u$ is a variable from the OLMS-OPDR data which is the total revenue of the union.

9. *Members*$_u$ is a variable from the OLMS-OPDR data which is the total number of members in the union.

10. *Has PAC*$_u$ is also taken from the OLMS-OPDR data, and equals 1 if the union has a PAC. This variable is called "Union has PAC Fund" in the original data.

Finally, we discuss in brief the models used in Tables 5 and 6 and their various permutations in the appendix. In all instances, we employ Ordinary Least Squares (OLS) regression. With the dichotomous outcome variable, these are the so-called 'linear probability model'. The main advantage of the linear model is that the coefficient estimates are very easy to interpret, particular for dummy variables or variables normalized to fall on the unit interval.

Appendix B: Additional models and discussion

Table B1: **Protectionist and Progressive Motives among Politically Active Unions**

	Joined opposing coalition$_{ua}$					
	1	2	3	4	5	6
Panel of national unions that joined opposing coalitions:						
Net-importing	0.11*	0.16***				
	(0.04)	(0.04)				
Offshorability	0.16	−0.26	−0.42*	−0.46**		
	(0.59)	(0.61)	(0.15)	(0.16)		
Routinization	0.25	0.05	−0.09	−0.08		
	(0.47)	(0.48)	(0.08)	(0.08)		
Offshor. · Rout.	0.11	0.77	1.13***	1.16***		
	(1.02)	(1.05)	(0.27)	(0.28)		
Partner labor rights	−0.35***		−0.24***		−0.25***	
	(0.07)		(0.03)		(0.03)	
Partner env. standards		−0.19*		−0.16***		−0.17***
		(0.07)		(0.03)		(0.03)
Intercept	0.04	0.08	0.21***	0.18***	0.21***	0.18***
	(0.24)	(0.25)	(0.04)	(0.05)	(0.01)	(0.01)
N	377	348	1261	1164	1651	1524
Sample	G	G+S	G+S+P	G+S+P	G+S	G+S

Notes: Outcome variable is *Joined opposing coalition*$_{ua}$ measuring whether union u joined coalition opposing trade agreement a. All models are linear probability models using OLS. G = unions representing (at least some) goods industries; S = unions representing service industries only; P = 'peak' unions representing a broad array of industries. National and local unions joining coalitions are any union HQ, branch, local, or committee that joined at least one of the opposing coalitions in our data. Locals are union branches or locals that have a parent union at the national level.

Labor union findings among union parents only

Table B2: **Topical content of union trade statements**

	% pars	Rank		% pars	Rank
Environment, farming and food: 4.4% of paragraphs					
Environment	3.2	10	Farmers	0.3	40
SPS/food safety	0.9	23			
Trade agreement creation and enforcement: 9.5% of paragraphs					
Process (Fast Track/input)	7.9	3	Benchmark	0.3	39
Enforcement	1.3	18			
Corporate power: 13.2% of paragraphs					
Corporate power	6.7	6	Dispute/ISDS	1.1	21
IP rules	5.4	7			
Economic justice: 14.1% of paragraphs					
Inequality	4.6	8	Foreign development	0.8	26
Infrastructure	2.8	11	Trade adj. assistance	0.8	27
Community dev.	2.2	13	Immigration	0.7	31
Poverty	1.4	16	Economic growth	0.7	33
Human rights: 16.0% of paragraphs					
Labor rights	10.6	2	Human rights	1.8	14
Mobilization	3.6	9			
Sovereignty concerns: 3.5% of paragraphs					
Regulatory sovereignty	1.6	15	Finance/banking	0.4	36
Privatization	1.2	19	Government procurement	0.3	38
Competition and protectionism: 29.8% of paragraphs					
Jobs	12.1	1	For. barriers remain	0.7	32
Offshoring	7.1	4	Import competition	0.6	34
Wages/pay	6.9	5	Dom. barriers remain	0.4	35
Trade deficits	0.9	24	FDI	0.4	37
Currency manipulation	0.7	30			
Public health: 1.9% of paragraphs					
Pharma/Medicines	1.0	22	Public health	0.9	25
Other topics: 2.0% of paragraphs					
Consumers	1.0	27	Security implications	0.6	33

Notes: Paragraphs are assigned one or more of 69 substantive topics (multiple topics are allocated proportionally). '% of pars' indicates the percentage of all paragraphs focused on a given topic; rank indicates the ranking of that topic among all topics. Only the top 40 most-discussed topics are provided (which are 98.6% of all substantive discussion).

Labor unions text analysis

Why are progressives better organized?

Our tentative explanation for the advantages of progressives and unions over populists in organizing to oppose trade builds off two observations. First, contemporary trade politics is multidimensional; the effects of trade liberalization are multifarious and complex; some degree of globalization is unavoidable; and trade is not a preeminent issue for most voters (or interest groups). Second, organization is collective action. We therefore must understand the distribution of political ability and resources among agents seeking to organize, as well as selective benefits from contributing to public goods and the costs and benefits of working together (Olson, 1965).

The spine of trade's progressive opposition is a group of very large union and non-union organizations with budgets in the tens or even hundreds of millions of dollars. As seen in Table 2, they repeatedly turn out to organize collective opposition to liberalization. They are then supplemented by a vast array of smaller groups whose participation is less reliable and whose political resources are fewer. Thus, progressive groups have benefitted from heterogeneities in size within their ranks as smaller organizations can rely on bigger organizations to pay the costs of organization.

Strikingly, the core, large groups that oppose trade are almost entirely organization's whose *raison d'etre* is not globalization politics. Instead, they are environmental groups, human rights NGOs, churches, unions, or progressive parties. The major progressive groups that have opposed trade therefore have built themselves in issue areas with much higher preference intensity (the environment, human rights, identity politics) and/or arise in spheres where selective benefits prevail (labor unions, religious organizations). Particular elements of the expanded trade agenda or of globalization politics then lead to their involvement in the complex politics of trade.

Progressive critiques about reshaping or reforming globalization – rather than ending it – are also usefully flexible. A uniformly anti-trade position is tricky to manage because opting out of globalization is impossible in the 21st century. Moreover, trade's effects are complicated so labor unions, for example, may support one agreement as they oppose some element of another. These complexities drain some of the verve from raw protectionism, and lead instead towards more flexible ideologies, like the multi-faceted progressive critique. In a similar way, progressive anti-globalism doesn't lock non-union groups into dogmatic opinions about trade issues but gives them a flexible set of critiques to deploy as appropriate (or as desired).

Populist nationalism doesn't have these advantages. It lacks a well-organized set of highly resourced groups focused on anti-globalism, and it also does not benefit from well-organized interest groups from other domains in right-wing politics who might dip into anti-trade politics. Socially conservative groups, gun rights groups, and right-wing churches have no stake in trade politics, while right-wing business groups, anti-tax groups, libertarians, think tanks, and general conservative groups are generally pro-trade. Anti-trade populist nationalism is also not a nuanced message, and so lacks the tactical flexibility that characterizes progressive anti-globalism.

Ultimately, economic nationalism is a mass movement, so populism probably needs a party. The Trump takeover of the Republican party was a rare moment of success after many notable failures over the years for Right-wing economic nationalists. But majoritarian systems have coalitional parties and the Republican coalition is an uneasy fit for economic populism given its heavy reliance on corporate America and laissez faire economic ideologies. This has made it hard to gain traction for populist anti-globalization groups on the right, because the marginal benefits of that organization are low. Modestly successful organizational

Table B3: **Lobbying and contributions among anti-trade groups**

	Among non-business groups			Among all groups		
	All	Unions	Nonunion	All	Unions	Nonunion
Lobbying on trade by anti-trade groups:						
%-age lobby expenditures	60.4	51.7	8.7	2.1	1.8	0.3
PAC contributions by anti-trade groups:						
%-age campaign contributions	46.4	41.9	4.6	14.1	12.3	1.9
...to Democrats	66.7	62.5	4.2	23.5	21.7	1.8
...to Republicans	20.1	15.1	5.1	5.6	3.7	1.9

Notes: Lobbying and PAC contributions data are from Center for Responsive Politics. Non-business lobbying groups exclude firms, trade associations, and other business associations (as coded by authors), but include all issue groups and unions. Non-business PACs include issues groups (CRP code J) and unions (CRP code L). PAC data excludes candidate and party committees.

efforts are likely to be easily thwarted by other Republican interest groups with huge resources and power within the party.

What are the effects of trade's progressive opposition?

So have progressives had any impact on policy? We make a start on this question by investigating the role of anti-trade interest groups in lobbying and contributions, which are important inputs to policy influence. On lobbying, for which we can determine a specific interest in trade, we present all left-wing or progressive groups that lobbied on trade from 1998-2016 in Table 3. These are 150 separate groups. Only 67 of these 150 groups actually joined any anti-trade coalition. While these numbers are modest, Table B3 shows their total lobby expenditures constitute an important share of lobby expenditures among issue groups and unions. Groups that joined our anti-trade coalitions account for more than 60% of all lobbying on trade by non-business groups; these expenditures are particularly dominated by unions (which are 51.7% of such expenditures).

We also examine the PAC contributions of the groups that have publicly opposed trade. We find that 152 of our groups joining anti-trade coalitions have directly given contributions. While the absolute numbers are again small, the shares of (non-candidate, non-party) PAC contributions are actually quite impressive. 46.4% of all non-business group PAC contributions come from groups that have joined these anti-trade coalitions. (These are mostly, but not exclusively, unions.) 14.4% of contributions, whether from producers or not, come from our anti-trade groups. These patterns are particularly reinforced looking at contributions to Democratic party candidates.

Anecdotal evidence of progressives' influence on trade policy are also available. First, trade's progressive opponents and allied unions have cultivated representation in the Congress and the Democratic Party. The House of Representatives, in particular, has a significant share of members that vote in a progressive fashion on trade issues, many of whom are members of the Congressional progressive caucus. Although these members are a minority, they raise progressive concerns around trade agreements. Democrats outside of the the Congress – from presidential candidates down to local elections – have also been influenced by progressive anti-globalization.

Second, trade's progressive opponents have shaped the trade agenda of the Congress and the Democratic Party platform. Progressives successfully fought to make labor standards and the environment principle trade

negotiating objective in the Trade Act of 2002. These demands were reinforced in the "May 10th agenda". The TRADE Act and "Better Deal" economic blueprint are more recent efforts by Democrats to reshape trade policymaking, though they lead to no passed legislation. The 2016 Democratic Party platform, for example, summarized Democrats' trade positions with a characteristic mix of progressive and protectionist concerns.

Finally, progressive concerns have had a tangible impact on the content of US trade agreements. The May 10th agreement led to fully enforceable labor and environmental provisions in US trade agreements of the Obama era. Modernizing these provisions was a particular focus of the TPP negotiations and the negotiation of the USMCA. Progressives have successfully fought against certain extensions of IP or dispute settlement rights for corporations. At the same time, it must be acknowledged that anti-trade progressives have had fewer outright victories than America's pro-globalization firms and industries. Their record of organizational success and ongoing, but modest, political impact suggests that they will continue to work as the most vital ideological component among America's anti-trade interest group coalitions.

Inclusion of countries when no coalitions materialized for labor market institutions models

Table B4 re-examines the findings from Table 5 (models 1,3,5 are recreated on the left of Table B4) and Table 6 (models 1,3,5 are recreated on the right of Table B4). In these models, the sample is modified to include the three US trade agreements that never generated an opposing coalition: Jordan, Bahrain, and Morocco. This is potentially important for the empirical testing because these countries do not attain the highest standards of labor rights protections (although they are also not at the lowest end of the spectrum either). We find strikingly similar substantive results relative to the original models. Finally, we also reinvestigated the effects of environmental ratings (and their interaction with union web statements on those issues) within a larger sample in Table B5. Due to data availability issues with the environmental ranking variable, the only case added for these models is Jordan. We see similar results to those presented in the main text.

Table B4: **Recreation of Tables 5 and 6 with inclusion of Jordan, Bahrain, and Morocco Cases**

	Joined opposing coalition$_{ua}$					
	1	2	3	4	5	6
	Coalition-joining unions:			National union HQs:		
Net-importing	0.08***			0.08*		
	(0.00)			(0.03)		
Offshorability	0.63***	−0.19***		−0.39	−0.18+	
	(0.16)	(0.05)		(0.40)	(0.08)	
Routinization	0.38***	−0.05+		0.00	−0.22***	
	(0.10)	(0.03)		(0.27)	(0.05)	
Offshor. · Rout.	−1.05***	0.29***		0.80	0.62***	
	(0.25)	(0.07)		(0.72)	(0.15)	
Website Labor Rights				0.43***	0.28***	0.32***
				(0.06)	(0.03)	(0.03)
Partner labor rights	−0.15***	−0.17***	−0.17***	−0.07	−0.09***	−0.08***
	(0.01)	(0.00)	(0.00)	(0.05)	(0.02)	(0.02)
Web LR · Partner LR				−0.64***	−0.31***	−0.33***
				(0.10)	(0.05)	(0.05)
ln Receipts				0.02*	0.01**	0.00
				(0.01)	(0.00)	(0.00)
ln Members				0.02*	0.00	0.01***
				(0.01)	(0.00)	(0.00)
Has PAC				−0.10	0.04*	0.01
				(0.05)	(0.02)	(0.01)
Intercept	−0.12	0.18***	0.14***	−0.37*	−0.05	−0.08*
	(0.06)	(0.02)	(0.00)	(0.13)	(0.04)	(0.03)
N	18736	464	30832	1760	35408	2208
Industries	G	G+S	G+S+P	G	G+S	G+S+P

Notes: Outcome variable is *Joined opposing coalition*$_{ua}$. All models are linear probability models using OLS.

Table B5: **Recreation of Tables 5 and 6 with inclusion of Jordan**

	Joined opposing coalition$_{ua}$					
	1	2	3	4	5	6
	Coalition-joining unions:			National union HQs:		
Net-importing	0.08***			0.08*		
	(0.00)			(0.03)		
Offshorability	0.63***	−0.19***		−0.39	−0.18+	
	(0.16)	(0.05)		(0.40)	(0.08)	
Routinization	0.38***	−0.05+		0.00	−0.22***	
	(0.10)	(0.03)		(0.27)	(0.05)	
Offshor. · Rout.	−1.05***	0.29***		0.80	0.62***	
	(0.25)	(0.07)		(0.72)	(0.15)	
Web Environment				0.43***	0.28***	0.32***
				(0.06)	(0.03)	(0.03)
Partner env. standards	−0.15***	−0.17***	−0.17***	−0.07	−0.09***	−0.08***
	(0.01)	(0.00)	(0.00)	(0.05)	(0.02)	(0.02)
Web Env · Partner env.				−0.64***	−0.31***	−0.33***
				(0.10)	(0.05)	(0.05)
ln Receipts				0.02*	0.01**	0.00
				(0.01)	(0.00)	(0.00)
ln Members				0.02*	0.00	0.01***
				(0.01)	(0.00)	(0.00)
Has PAC				−0.10	0.04*	0.01
				(0.05)	(0.02)	(0.01)
Intercept	−0.12	0.18***	0.14***	−0.37*	−0.05	−0.08*
	(0.06)	(0.02)	(0.00)	(0.13)	(0.04)	(0.03)
N	18736	464	30832	1760	35408	2208
Industries	G	G+S	G+S+P	G	G+S	G+S+P

Notes: Outcome variable is *Joined opposing coalition*$_{ua}$. All models are linear probability models using OLS.

Models interacting net-importingness and labor or environmental standards

In this section, we consider whether net-importingness might make it more likely for weak labor or environmental standards to drive labor union opposition to trade agreements. This would be consistent with an approach wherein unions are driven by protectionist concerns rather than sincere opposition to harms to foreign workers or the environment. We test this proposition by interacting the partner labor or environmental standards variables with the net-importingness dummy.

Overall, we don't see consistent evidence in line with this pattern. The results of the panel analysis of all politically active unions (columns 1 and 2 of Table B6) are consistent with this idea. The results among politically active national unions only (columns 3 and 4 of Table B6) and among all national union hqs (Table B7) are not consistent with this claim, however.

Table B6: **Protectionist and Progressive Motives among Politically Active Unions (Logit version)**

	Joined opposing coalition$_{ua}$			
	1	2	3	4
Panel of national and local unions that joined opposing coalitions:				
Net-importing	0.18***	0.14***	0.19*	0.13
	(0.01)	(0.01)	(0.07)	(0.07)
Partner labor rights	−0.05***		−0.29***	
	(0.01)		(0.08)	
Partner labor rights·Net-importing	−0.24***		−0.22	
	(0.01)		(0.15)	
Partner env. standards		−0.03+		−0.21*
		(0.01)		(0.09)
Partner env. standards·Net-importing		−0.14***		0.07
		(0.02)		(0.16)
Offshorability	0.66**	0.48*	0.08	−0.23
	(0.20)	(0.21)	(0.60)	(0.61)
Routinization	0.36**	0.21	0.18	0.08
	(0.12)	(0.13)	(0.48)	(0.49)
Offshor. · Rout.	−1.07***	−0.76*	0.26	0.71
	(0.30)	(0.32)	(1.03)	(1.06)
Intercept	−0.16+	−0.09	0.05	0.07
	(0.08)	(0.08)	(0.24)	(0.25)
N	15223	14052	377	348
Sample	G	G	G	G

Notes: Outcome variable is *Joined opposing coalition*$_{ua}$ measuring whether union u joined coalition opposing trade agreement a. All models are OLS. G = unions representing (at least some) goods industries. National and local unions joining coalitions are any union HQ, branch, local, or committee that joined at least one of the opposing coalitions in our data. Locals are union branches or locals that have a parent union at the national level.

Table B7: **Protectionist and Progressive Motives among Panel of National Unions (Logit version)**

	Joined opposing coalition$_{ua}$	
	1	2
Panel of national unions:		
Net-importing	0.09	0.10
	(0.05)	(0.06)
Partner labor rights	−0.05	
	(0.07)	
Net-importing·Partner labor rights	−0.02	
	(0.12)	
Website Labor Rights	0.42***	
	(0.07)	
Web LR · Partner LR	−0.60***	
	(0.12)	
Partner env. standards		−0.07
		(0.08)
Net-importing·Partner env. standards		0.02
		(0.13)
Web Environment		0.32***
		(0.09)
Web Env · Partner env.		−0.36^{+}
		(0.17)
Offshorability	−0.49	−0.46
	(0.48)	(0.53)
Routinization	−0.02	0.12
	(0.32)	(0.34)
Offshor. · Rout.	1.01	0.91
	(0.87)	(0.94)
ln Receipts	0.02*	0.02*
	(0.01)	(0.01)
ln Members	0.03*	0.04**
	(0.01)	(0.01)
Has PAC	−0.12	−0.13
	(0.06)	(0.07)
Intercept	−0.45**	−0.54**
	(0.16)	(0.16)
N	377	348
Industries	G	G

Notes: Outcome variable is *Joined opposing coalition*$_{ua}$ measures whether union u joined coalition opposing trade agreement a. All models are OLS. G = unions representing (at least some) goods industries. National unions are national union HQs based in the US with at least 100 members or $10000 in receipts, and operating after 2011.